

CMPE2150 PCB Project B

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Tip

I’m going to stop reminding you to increment version numbers, check in and push at major milestones, because you already do that reflexively.

Schematic Annotation

Now that we have the basic symbols and connections input, we’re going to modify this schematic, which currently represents the design of the circuit in a generalized, abstract way to a schematic that also contains (but does not always display) information about actual physical components and characteristics

By the time we are finished, KiCAD will be satisfied that it knows enough to help us lay out a PCB design, and our electrical rule check (ERC) will be clean.

Part 1 - Adding Values and Footprints

We will now visit each of the components in the schematic to correctly set:

- Its *value* (e.g. R_1 is $2.2k\Omega$), which you may have already selected when placing the symbol on the schematic.
- Its *footprint*, which is the actual, physical part description. It may depend on the manufacturer, type of part, or package.

In general, you can do both by double clicking on the symbol with the selection tool or hover-selecting and hitting the *E* (Edit) key. There, you can change the values in the appropriate fields. We will take them in turn.

1. We will first annotate each resistor (except the potentiometer). Confirm one has the correct value (for example, R_1 should have a value of “2.2k”). Choose an SMD 0805¹ footprint (search terms include “R”, “SMD”, and “0805”) for that resistor. Continue and do the same for all ten standard resistors.

Tip

Once you have done the first resistor, you can open the symbol table (*Tools* → *Edit Symbol Fields*). There, as you can see, you can change fields for groups of components and manually edit values. When doing a lot of changes to values and footprints, this tool is invaluable. Note that, as you would expect, you can copy and paste values and footprints between symbols.

2. Now do the diodes, excepting the LED. First, select one and edit (*E*) it. If the symbol isn’t already 1N4005, you can select “Change Symbol” and choose a new library identifier, then click the library button to change it, and “Change” to enact the change. All should be 1N4005G diodes, which you can update the “Value” field to display, with the same SMD-0805 footprint. Again, if you edit them in the *Symbol Table* you can do all at once.

Note

Neatness always counts! As you change the display values of some of these symbols, take the time to move the labels on the schematic around to make it easy to read the values. In particular, avoid labels overlapping with symbols or wires. Remember you can rotate labels, too.

3. Do the NPN transistors: value is “2N3904”, change to the appropriate symbol if necessary, and select an SOT-23² footprint.
4. Do the same for the 2N3906 PNP transistors.
5. For the two electrolytic capacitors, C_1 and C_2 , we’ll select some through-hole barrel caps.
6. The LM7805 should be in a T0220³ package footprint.
7. The LM339 should be in a SOIC-14⁴ package footprint. Of course, a real LM339 actually has four comparators, and we only need

¹ Surface Mount Device, 0.08 inches by 0.05 inches.

² Small-Outline Transistor #23

³ Transistor Outline #220, a standard through-hole package for transistors very common for voltage regulators, which are also three-pin.

⁴ Small Outline Integrated Circuit - 14 pins. A standard surface-mount package for DIP-style chips. Similar to the ICs that you use in your breadboard, but significantly smaller and with gull-wing leads suitable for surface mount soldering and pick-and-place machines.

one. In the symbol properties, make sure that “Unit A” is selected, which means the first of the four comparator units. Try changing it to “B” or “C” and note what happens to the pin numbers on the schematic before changing back to “A”.

That should set us up with the parts that are already in the KiCAD database.

Part 2 - Import

Some devices that we want to use aren’t already in the KiCAD symbol library. However, device vendors are very good about supporting circuit and PCB designers, and most major suppliers go out of their way to make sure it’s easy to use their parts in a new design.

1. Let’s start with the fuse. I’d rather not deal with mounting a fuse holder and replacing expendable fuses. Let’s go to a *polyfuse*, which will heat up and automatically kill the power above a certain current, then gradually cool down and reset on its own. First, change the fuse’s symbol to the generic polyfuse symbol in the symbol editor. Unfortunately, we don’t have much in the way of real polyfuses in our default KiCAD library. Let’s fix that. In the below, we’ll use a project specific library, to avoid modifying our global library, but if it’s a part that you expect to use on more than one p
 - a. Go to Digikey⁵ and search for the Littelfuse NANOSMDC016F-2, which is in a SMD-1206 form factor polyfuse⁶.
 - b. On that part’s page, click on the link for the EDA/CAD Models. In the next page, click on “Select Download Format”. Choose “KiCAD (V6 and Later)” and Download. Create a folder in your KiCad Project (I use one named `lib`) and copy the extracted files into it.
 - c. Now you can import it into your KiCAD symbol library, possibly by just double clicking on it, depending on your platform and version. There should be a file in the downloaded symbol/model that describes how to import the `*.kicad_sym` symbol using *Preferences* → *Manage Symbol Libraries* → *Global Libraries* from the main (not Schematic Editor) window then browsing (little folder icon) and opening the file to add to your library.
 - d. Perform a similar procedure to import the `*.kicad_mod` model file Footprint using *Preferences* → *Manage Footprint Libraries* → *Global Libraries*. Note that Footprint libraries are added by folder, so you won’t be able to see the file—just select the folder that contains it.

⁵ <https://www.digikey.ca/>

⁶ Of course, in the real world for a real project, you would compare this part to other parts, check the availability and price, and probably order some.

- e. Now, go to your schematic and edit the polyfuse symbol, to select what you just imported. Try searching on the NANOS-MDC... part number for the symbol. The footprint you just imported can be found under the folder name that you selected (in my case, it show as a new dropdown named `local`).
- f. While you're in the symbol table, update the datasheet for the polyfuse to an appropriate datasheet on the web and change the value to `NANOSMDC016F-2`.

2.

Submission

When you have completed the above and checked and reviewed your work, increment the version number (yet again), check in and push the schematic design. Ask your instructor to review your schematic with you, and make any changes they require. When you are done (after, of course, incrementing the version number, checking in and pushing) submit the schematic.